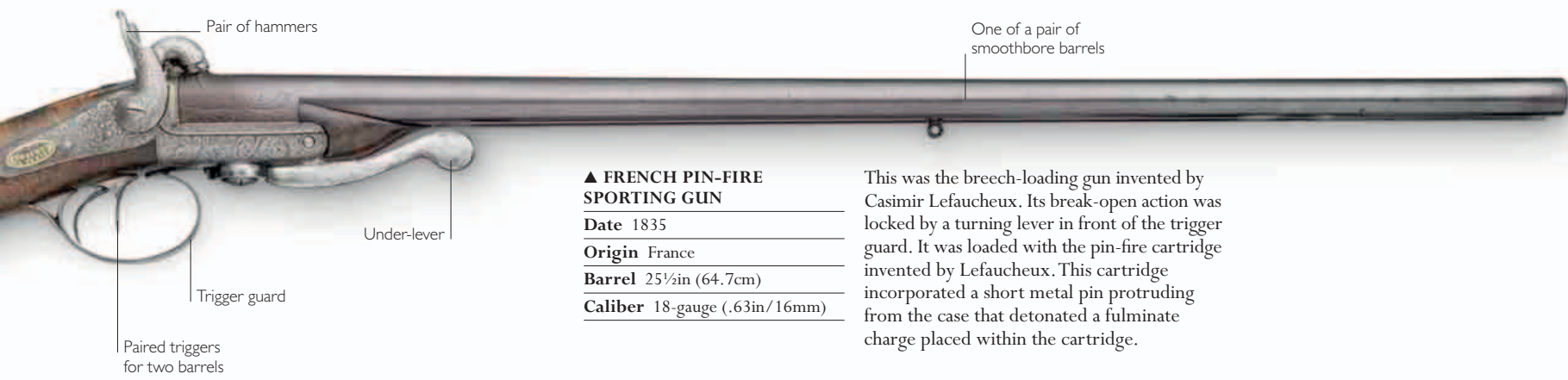
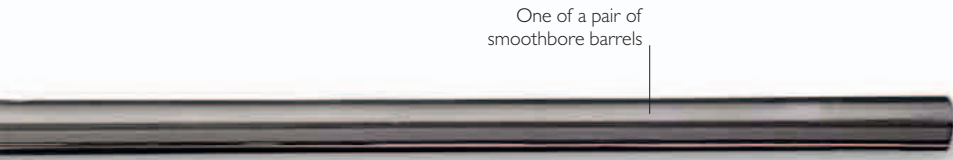




▲ FRENCH PIN-FIRE SPORTING GUN
Date 1835
Origin France
Barrel 25½in (64.7cm)
Caliber 18-gauge (.63in/16mm)

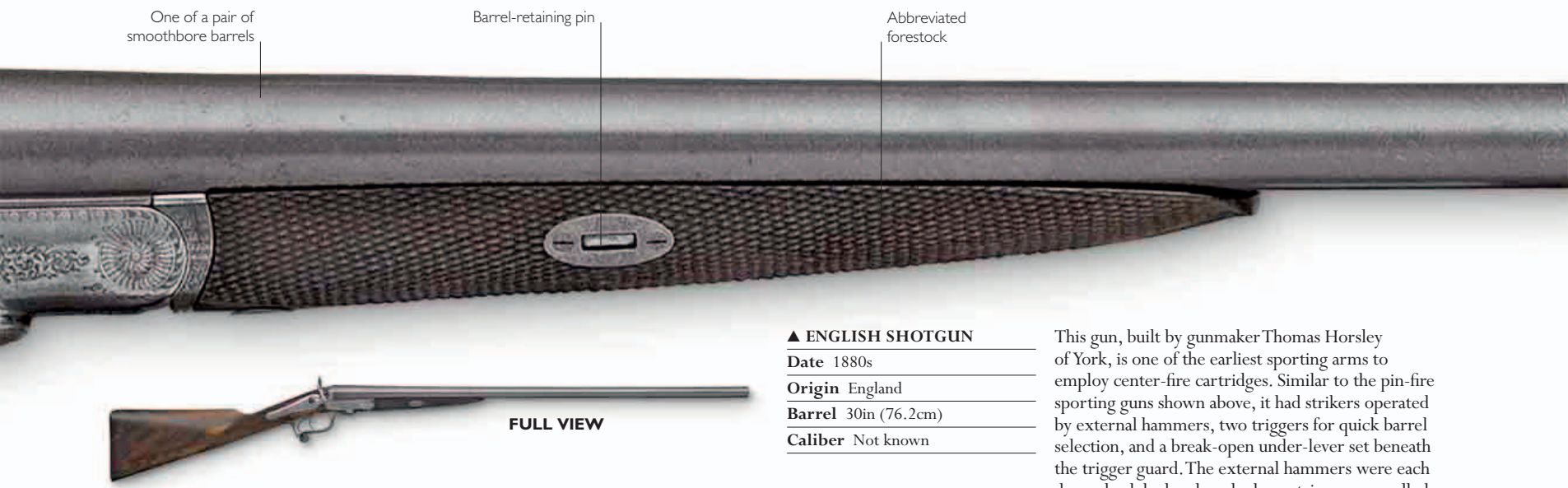
This was the breech-loading gun invented by Casimir Lefauchaux. Its break-open action was locked by a turning lever in front of the trigger guard. It was loaded with the pin-fire cartridge invented by Lefauchaux. This cartridge incorporated a short metal pin protruding from the case that detonated a fulminate charge placed within the cartridge.



One of a pair of smoothbore barrels

◀ ENGLISH PIN-FIRE SHOTGUN
Date c.1860
Origin UK
Length 30in (76.2cm)
Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.54mm)

Casimir Lefauchaux's pin-fire system remained popular with shotgun-armed hunters (particularly in Britain and France), even after it had been outmoded by the center-fire cartridge. This example, with back-action locks and a side-mounted breech-locking lever, is finely finished, but with little in the way of decoration. It was the work of Samuel and Charles Smith of London.



One of a pair of smoothbore barrels

Barrel-retaining pin

Abbreviated forestock

FULL VIEW

▲ ENGLISH SHOTGUN
Date 1880s
Origin England
Barrel 30in (76.2cm)
Caliber Not known

This gun, built by gunmaker Thomas Horsley of York, is one of the earliest sporting arms to employ center-fire cartridges. Similar to the pin-fire sporting guns shown above, it had strikers operated by external hammers, two triggers for quick barrel selection, and a break-open under-lever set beneath the trigger guard. The external hammers were each drawn back by hand, and when a trigger was pulled, it connected with the outer part of the striker, which struck the center-fire cartridge in the breech.



Abbreviated forestock

One of a pair of smoothbore barrels

▲ HOLLAND AND HOLLAND SHOTGUN
Date 1878
Origin England
Barrel 30in (76.2cm)
Caliber 12-gauge (.73in/18.54mm)

Holland and Holland is known for the superb quality of its bird-hunting shotguns. This hammerless shotgun with an under-lever has a classic English-style stock—it has no pistol grip. It also has an unusual breech-loading mechanism—its under-lever not only opened and closed the breech, but also cocked the enclosed box-lock action.